



CITY OF CAMBRIDGE

CITY COUNCIL FINAL ACTIONS • MARCH 30, 2026

Regular Meeting

Sullivan Chamber

5:30 PM

Cambridge City Hall, 795 Massachusetts Ave, Cambridge, MA 02139

Published March 31, 2026 4:09 PM

ROLL CALL

Present: Councillor Ayah A. Al-Zubi
Vice Mayor Burhan Azeem – 5:36 PM
Councillor Timothy R. Flaherty – 5:46 PM
Councillor Marc McGovern
Councillor Patricia Nolan
Councillor E. Denise Simmons – REMOTE 5:48 PM, IN PERSON 6:08 PM
Councillor Jivan Sobrinho-Wheeler
Councillor Catherine Zusy
Mayor Sumbul Siddiqui

Absent: None

I. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

II. SUBMISSION OF THE RECORD

1. Minutes of the Joint Roundtable/Working Meeting of the Cambridge City Council and the School Committee was held on Wednesday, March 4, 2026.

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV9

III. PUBLIC COMMENTS

IV. CITY MANAGER'S AGENDA

1. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a federal update including an update on relevant court cases.

CMA 2026-69

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Simmons

2. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appointment of Will MacArthur as a new member of the Open Data Review Board for a term of two years, effective March 30, 2026.

CMA 2026-70

RESULT: Approved and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

3. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to plans for replacement of the City's legacy Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) software system.

CMA 2026-71

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV9

4. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to an overview of the City's initial Artificial Intelligence efforts.

CMA 2026-72

RESULT: CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

5. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 26-12 regarding Harvard Square pedestrianization.

CMA 2026-75

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV9

6. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 26-03 regarding establishing a formal policy that clearly defines the City's role and financial responsibilities in supporting large-scale public events hosted by Cambridge-based non-profit and not-for-profit organizations, including criteria for fee waivers.

CMA 2026-76

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler

7. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 26-09 regarding and report back to the Council on (i) legal parameters related to City funding and Tourism Destination Marketing District restrictions, and (ii) oversight and accountability related to the operation of the visitor information kiosk, and related governance expectations, including alignment with City priorities.
CMA 2026-77

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV9

8. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 26-17 regarding proposed updates to the City's Welcoming Community Ordinance.
CMA 2026-74

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV9

- A. Chapter 2.129 Welcoming Community Ordinance
PASSED TO A SECOND READING IN COUNCIL MARCH 30, 2026
ELIGIBLE TO BE ORDAINED APRIL 20, 2026
ORD 2026-03

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

V. POLICY ORDERS

1. That the City Manager is requested to direct the Law Department to work with the Cambridge Public Health Department to amend and update language in Chapter 8.28 of the Cambridge Municipal Code.
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
POR 2026-65

RESULT: Adopted VV9

2. That the City Manager is requested to initiate the planning process for Cambridge 400 and as part of this, to convene a Cambridge 400 Advisory Committee composed of members representing the range of stakeholders whose participation is needed to guide this work.
COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR ZUSY
POR 2026-66

RESULT: Adopted as Amended VV9

3. City Council support of An Act promoting housing stability for older adults across the Commonwealth.
COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR ZUSY
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY
POR 2026-67

RESULT: Adopted as Amended VV9

4. City Council support of S.2721/H.5217, An Act restricting the use of rodenticides in the environment.
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
POR 2026-68

RESULT: Adopted VV9

5. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant departments to review the current legal landscape and provide recommendations for how to regulate construction of data centers in Cambridge.
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR ZUSY
COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
POR 2026-69

RESULT: Adopted as Amended VV9

6. That the City Council go on record proclaiming April 6–12, 2026 as Cambridge Public Health Week in special appreciation of the dedicated work of City government, community organizations, health professionals, businesses, and residents in advancing health equity and building a healthier, more resilient Cambridge.
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
POR 2026-70

RESULT: Adopted [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

7. That the City Council go on record proclaiming April 13–20, 2026 as International Dark Sky Week in the City of Cambridge, and calls upon all residents, businesses, institutions, and City departments to join in observing this important week by raising awareness of light pollution, adopting responsible

outdoor lighting practices, and supporting the protection of our shared night sky as a precious and finite resource.

MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
POR 2026-71

RESULT: Adopted [9-0-0]

VI. CALENDAR

TABLED

8. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments to raise the fee of the parking permit program for all residents to \$75, consider how to include a self-identified check off option so as not to increase administrative costs for a subsidized fee of \$25 for residents who live in affordable housing, are enrolled in a program such as SNAP or are low income, remove the senior exemption for the residential parking permit program and lower the number of cars that individual residents are allowed to get a residential parking permit for from four to two
POR 2026-32

RESULT: Adopted as Amended by Substitution [7-2-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Simmons

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

VII. COMMUNICATIONS

1. Communications for Regular City Council March 30, 2026
COM 2026-14

RESULT: Placed on File VV9

VIII. COMMUNICATIONS FROM OTHER CITY OFFICERS

1. A communication was received from Interim City Clerk Paula Crane, regarding an update regarding legislative activity.
COF 2026-45

RESULT: Placed on File VV9

2. A communication from Mayor Siddiqui transmitting a memorandum regarding information from the School Committee.
COF 2026-46

RESULT: Placed on File VV9

3. A communication from Mayor Siddiqui transmitting a memorandum regarding updates from the City Clerk Preliminary Screening Committee.
COF 2026-47

RESULT: Placed on File VV9

IX. APPENDED INFORMATION

1. Awaiting Report Status Update 3.30.26

AWAITING REPORT LIST

1. That the City Manager is requested to work with the School Department, the Department of Public Works, and other relevant departments to ensure that all city owned parking lots, with a focus on school complexes, including the still under construction parking at Tobin/Darby Vassal school complex, could be made available for after-hours use by residents. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-29
Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-02
2. The City Manager is requested to consult with the appropriate City departments, including the City Solicitor's Office, to establish a formal policy that clearly defines the City's role and financial responsibilities in supporting large-scale public events hosted by Cambridge-based non-profit and not-for-profit organizations. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-48
Councillor Simmons, Councillor McGovern
AR 2026-03

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV8

3. The City Manager is requested to work with all relevant departments to seek input from the community as well as direct outreach to condo owners and short-term rental operators and develop additional recommendations based on the discussion in the Ordinance Committee. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-51
Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui
AR 2026-04
4. Review the previous home rule petition and prepare a new petition that would allow Cambridge to enact a Real Estate Transfer Fee to be sent to the state legislature. Original Awaiting Report AR-25-69
Councillor Nolan, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern
AR 2026-06
5. Restricting Eligibility for On-Street Resident Parking Permits in New Transit-Oriented Developments. Original Awaiting Report 31839
Councillor Zusy, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-07

6. Direct the City Solicitor and the Community Development Department to review and report back to the Council on (i) legal parameters related to City funding and Tourism Destination Marketing District restrictions, and (ii) oversight and accountability related to the operation of the visitor information kiosk, and related governance expectations, including alignment with City priorities.
Original Awaiting Report ID #31841
Councillor Simmons, Councillor Flaherty
AR 2026-09

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV9

7. Work with relevant departments to prepare for a Council discussion on best future uses for City-owned properties and the processes for redevelopment. Original Awaiting Report #31842
Councillor Nolan, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Al-Zubi
AR 2026-10
8. That the City Manager work with relevant City departments to prioritize pilot projects in 2026 without the use of a consultant for an extensive pedestrianization study, and in the medium-term consider how additional pedestrianization of a section of Brattle Street by restoring two-way traffic to JFK Street could enhance the Square.
Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Zusy
AR 2026-12

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV9

9. That the City Manager conduct a comprehensive review of existing safety and security measures at Cambridge City Hall, including an assessment of physical access controls, visitor screening practices, on-site security staffing and training, emergency response and evacuation protocols, and the use of security technologies such as surveillance systems and alarm monitoring.
Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Simmons
AR 2026-14
10. The City Manager is requested to direct the appropriate departments to review the city's digital equity work to date, including the study's recommendations and all steps taken since the study conclusion in order to update the evaluation of existing internet access programs, assessing whether residents' digital needs are or could be better provided for and to propose how we can better meet their needs and to report back to the Council by June 2026 on internet access programs.
Councillor Zusy, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Vice Mayor Azeem
AR 2026-18
11. The City Manager is requested to direct the Community Development Department (CDD) to examine the feasibility, legal considerations, and administrative requirements of permitting qualified third-party guarantors or co-signers for applicants to Inclusionary Housing units and provide recommendations as to whether such a policy could responsibly expand access to these units.
Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Simmons
AR 2026-16
12. The City Manager is requested to direct the Law Department to draft ordinance language restricting the use of City-owned or City-controlled property, facilities, resources, and personnel for the purposes of federal civil immigration enforcement, and that the Law Department evaluate

whether these protections should be adopted as an amendment to the Welcoming Community Ordinance.

Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Al-Zubi

AR 2026-17

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV9

13. That the City Manager is requested to assess opportunities to improve the consistency of how meeting information is posted and accessed on the City's website.
Councillor Simmons, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler
AR 2026-19
14. That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to produce and deliver to the City Council, prior to the adoption of the FY27 Capital Budget, a consolidated capital lifecycle reconciliation for all major capital initiatives.
Councillor Simmons, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Flaherty
AR 2026-20
15. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments as well as the Election Commissioners to review guidance from the IRS and consult with other municipalities in order to simplify our processes for paying election workers.
Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Zusy
AR 2026-22
16. That the City Manager is requested to work with the City Council and relevant City departments on the process by which Cambridge can expand free early child care offerings, including models for means-tested programming, and exploration of non-City funding sources, from the state or foundations.
Councillor Nolan, Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui
AR 2026-23
17. That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to confer with the Community Development Department, Finance Department, Law Department, and other relevant departments to explore all steps towards advancing social housing in Cambridge. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-58
Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler
AR 2026-24
18. That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to instruct all City departments, boards, commissions, and offices to discontinue all official posting and engagement on X within 60 days; and to include an explanation of why the City will no longer use X.
Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-25
19. That the City Manager is requested to direct the Community Development Department and the Transportation Department to meet with Harvard's Office of Community Relations and the Longwood Collective (MASCO) to harmonize institutional bus protocols with public-facing commitments.
Councillor Al-Zubi, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-26

20. That the City Manager is requested to direct relevant City departments and staff to examine and report back on whether the city can require single-stall public bathrooms to be gender-neutral. Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Nolan, Vice Mayor Azeem
AR 2026-27

X. ADJOURNMENT
